

Τιμοκρέων ὁ Ῥόδιος

Timocreon of Rhodes Against Themistocles

eul_aid: bpy

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)

Dialect: *Δωρική* [Doric \(frg\)](#)

Domain: *Ποίησης* [Poetry](#)

Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Timocreon of Rhodes was a 5th-century BCE Greek lyric poet and athlete from Ialysus on Rhodes. A contemporary of the Persian Wars, his life was defined by political conflict, most notably his bitter feud with the Athenian statesman Themistocles. Ancient sources report that Timocreon was exiled from Rhodes for medizing, or siding with the Persians, and that Themistocles later blocked his return, a grievance that fueled his poetry. He was also a victorious pancratium athlete at the Isthmian Games.

His work survives only in fragments, primarily scolia, or drinking songs, and invective poems. Approximately ten fragments remain, preserved by authors like Plutarch and Athenaeus. The most famous is a scolia launching a vitriolic personal attack on Themistocles for corruption and his role in Timocreon's exile.

Timocreon is a significant figure for his use of lyric poetry, particularly the scolia, for sharp political and personal invective. His fragments offer a highly partisan but valuable contemporary perspective on the political rivalries following the Persian Wars. He exemplifies the ideal of the athlete-poet and demonstrates how personal animosity could shape literary expression in classical Greece.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Invective Against Themistocles](#) · 25 passages